BUCATINI ALL’AMATRICIANA

REGION	SERVES	TOTAL TIME
Central	**4-6**	**40 min**

INGREDIENTS

28 g	Olive oil
160 g	Guanciale, thinly sliced
456 g	Tomato passata
½ tsp	Dried red chile flakes
624 g	Extruded bucatini
30 g	Pecorino romano
22 g	Pecorino romano, for garnish

METHOD

1. Set a large saute pan or Dutch oven over medium-low heat and put a paper-towel-lined plate beside it.
2. Add the oil and the guanciale. Render the fat and take the pieces just to the edge of golden without letting them brown, 5 to 8 minutes. They crisp further once they leave the pan.
3. Lift a quarter of the guanciale out with a slotted spoon and drain it on the paper towels. Those pieces are the garnish.
4. Drop the heat to low. Add the passata and the chile flakes and cook 8 to 10 minutes, until the raw edge of the tomato is gone and the flavors have knitted together. You are not trying to reduce the sauce.
5. Salt a large pot of water generously and bring it to the boil.
6. Cook the bucatini 5 to 8 minutes, to al dente.
7. Move the pasta across with tongs or a pasta basket, add a splash of pasta water and toss 1 to 2 minutes to marry. Take the pan off the heat and toss 30 g of the pecorino through. If the sauce feels tight, loosen it with more pasta water and keep tossing. It is married when it clings with a glossy sheen.
8. Divide into bowls and finish with the remaining pecorino and the reserved guanciale.

NOTES

No onion and no garlic here. In Amatrice the sauce is tomato, pecorino and guanciale, with chile flakes at most.
The dish takes more heat than the ½ tsp of chile given, so scale the chile up if you want it hotter.
Pulling a quarter of the guanciale out before the tomato goes in keeps those pieces crisp for the top. The rest softens into the sauce.
The passata only cooks long enough to lose its rawness. Reducing it tips the balance away from the pecorino and guanciale.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

_____